



Name: Cohort/Batch: Date: Score:

CASSANDRA PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Distributed Systems

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Cassandra and what problem in Distributed Systems does it solve?

Q6 How does Cassandra handle reliability and high availability?

Q2 What are the core components or concepts in Cassandra?

Q7 What observability does Cassandra provide out of the box?

Q3 How does Cassandra compare to its main alternatives?

Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in Cassandra?

Q4 How do you get started with Cassandra for a new project?

Q9 What security best practices apply when running Cassandra?

Q5 What configuration options most affect Cassandra's behavior in production?

Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting Cassandra?



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Cassandra is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

Cassandra is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Distributed Systems domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A6 Cassandra provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling.

Cassandra provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A2 Cassandra has key building blocks that work

Primitives

Cassandra has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A7 Cassandra exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces.

Cassandra exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A3 Cassandra trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

Cassandra trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose Cassandra when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches.

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A4 Install Cassandra via its package manager or binary release.

Gotchas

Install Cassandra via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A9 Run Cassandra with the principle of least privilege

Assessment

Run Cassandra with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels.

Concurrency

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.

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